



# Things To Keep In Mind When SELECTING AN OSCILLOSCOPE

An oscilloscope is an indispensable tool for testing and analysis in a wide range of fields and applications. It is an essential instrument for anyone who designs, develops, or fixes electronic equipment. Therefore, it is imperative to be familiar with the 'scope-jargon' and be able to select the right one for your application

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**A**n oscilloscope, commonly known as a scope, is an instrument that graphically depicts electrical signals and shows how those signals evolve over time. Engineers use them to analyse circuits and assess signal quality. A scope displays the frequency of the signal, whether a broken signal component is causing distortion, how much of the signal is noise, and much more.

For the scope of this article (pun intended), we will go through some crucial parameters that you need to consider while investing in an oscilloscope.

Before looking at the technical specifications of the oscilloscope you are about to buy, you need to know what types of signals you will measure using

the oscilloscope—will you frequently work with square waves or sine waves or both? What's the approximate voltage and frequency range you are hoping to measure? In short, you need to be very clear about how you are going to use the oscilloscope.

## End application and type

Depending on your application, you need to choose a scope with a variety of features that work for you, such as bandwidth, storage capacity, sampling rates, portability, maximum memory depth, etc. To get the best performance possible, a proper combination of these features is required. Moreover, certain types of oscilloscopes are better suited for some functions than others. For example, digital